# 2E Familars

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**Dave Brookshaw**

Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 2081

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06-15-2015, 11:02 AM #16

> *Originally posted by **crabbadon***
> *Dave: If you sac a dot of willpower on a spell and it runs out or is dispelled, does the willpower dot recover?*

You have to buy it back.

**Dave Brookshaw**

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**Strill**

Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1261

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06-15-2015, 11:11 AM #17

> *Originally posted by **Dave Brookshaw***
> *You have to buy it back.*

So then Familiars are no longer a Merit? Because if they were, then they'd be covered under sanctity of merits.

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**Dave Brookshaw**

Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 2081

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06-15-2015, 04:06 PM #18

> *Originally posted by **Strill***
> *So then Familiars are no longer a Merit? Because if they were, then they'd be covered under sanctity of merits.*

If you read what crabaddon actually asked, you'll see they asked about *Willpower*, and no, you don't get the xp refunded if a spell you spent a Willpower dot to relinquish gets cancelled.

If you have bought a familiar with Merit dots, and it gets killed beyond re-binding, then yes, you would get the Merit dots back.

*Last edited by Dave Brookshaw; 06-15-2015, 08:00 PM.*

**Dave Brookshaw**

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**Ashenrogue**

Member

Join Date: Feb 2014
Posts: 1388

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06-15-2015, 05:52 PM #19

So if someone dispels your merit bought familiar link you would be better off killing the spirit and using the sanctity of merits to refund the cost and use it to rebuy the Familiar merit rather than waste willpower/xp to reestablish the link yourself? That seems kinda...yea...

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**Prometheus**

Member

06-15-2015, 05:56 PM #20

Hmm... I would like to know, what *is* the maximum rank for a familiar anyway? And can you bind your own daimon? Or do they have a bit different mechanics? Daimons always seemed a bit different to me from the typical Virtue and Vice Goetia with their potential link to the Supernal (making the mage more powerful and eliminating his flaws).

*Last edited by Prometheus; 06-15-2015, 06:03 PM.*

Join Date: May 2015
Posts: 479

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**Freemind**
Member

Join Date: Apr 2014
Posts: 1333

06-15-2015, 05:57 PM #21

*Originally posted by **Ashenrogue***
*So if someone dispels your merit bought familiar link you would be better off killing the spirit and using the sanctity of merits to refund the cost and use it to rebuy the Familiar merit rather than waste willpower/xp to reestablish the link yourself? That seems kinda...yea...*

Well, you could always ask someone else to rebind it. And it does mean getting a new spirit to volunteer to be a familiar after you killed the last one... which might not draw many in.

But yeah, it is gimicky

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**Enokh**
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 474

06-15-2015, 05:59 PM #22

*Originally posted by **Ashenrogue***
*So if someone dispels your merit bought familiar link you would be better off killing the spirit and using the sanctity of merits to refund the cost and use it to rebuy the Familiar merit rather than waste willpower/xp to reestablish the link yourself? That seems kinda...yea...*

This presumes that you can buy the familiar merit after creation, which is almost assuredly wrong.

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**Ashenrogue**
Member

06-15-2015, 06:01 PM #23

*Originally posted by **Freemind***
*Well, you could always ask someone else to rebind it. And it does mean getting a new spirit to volunteer to be a familiar after you killed the last one... which might not draw many in.*

*But yeah, it is gimicky*

Join Date: Feb 2014
Posts: 1388

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I kinda assumed if you had to buy it as a merit it meant you didn't readily have access to someone who could do it for you, which is the main reason I brought it up. I mean sure, you can ST fiat that someone who knows how to randomly shows up and all that, but as you put it, it feels sort of gimmicky.

> *Originally posted by **Enokh***
>
> *This presumes that you can buy the familiar merit after creation, which is almost assuredly wrong.*

I don't see how that assumption is 'almost assuredly wrong'. It wasn't restricted to character creation in 1e and hasn't been said or hinted at being restricted now. The only reason I'd even see a reason for it at this point is because of the gimmicky way in which you'd be best off getting a new one.

*Last edited by Ashenrogue; 06-15-2015, 06:16 PM.*

👍 2

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**Freemind**
Member

Join Date: Apr 2014
Posts: 1333

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06-15-2015, 06:42 PM #24

Well, willpower is only 1xp per dot. It isn't as XP intensive as 1e to replace it (8xp... woof).

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**Ashenrogue**
Member

Join Date: Feb 2014
Posts: 1388

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06-15-2015, 06:57 PM #25

> *Originally posted by **Freemind***
> *Well, willpower is only 1xp per dot. It isn't as XP intensive as 1e to replace it (8xp... woof).*

That's true enough. Forgot how much cheaper its become. That said, I could still imagine going through with the alternate method if you really didn't want to pay that 1xp, or if it happened often enough that the overall cost was beginning to become a problem.

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**Freemind**
Member

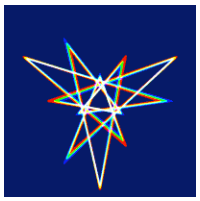
Join Date: Apr 2014
Posts: 1333

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06-15-2015, 07:07 PM #26

Very true. I think I would limit that experience for my players. That, or give beats for losing the bond, any inconveniences as well as the efforts meant to re-establish it, totalling at the end just enough XP for a new bond

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**branford**
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1904

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06-15-2015, 07:49 PM #27

> *Originally posted by **Ashenrogue***
> *So if someone dispels your merit bought familiar link you would be better off killing the spirit and using the sanctity of merits to refund the cost and use it to rebuy the Familiar merit rather than waste willpower/xp to reestablish the link yourself? That seems kinda...yea...*

That may be true under a strict interpretation of the rules mechanics, but not within the spirit of the setting.

I could easily imagine that not rebinding / saving your familiar would be considered very bad form in mage society, and would seriously impugn your mage's reputation among his fellows and in the spirit world (or astral, among ghosts and the underworld, etc.). Killing you familiar, bound or not, would probably a serious Wisdom sin with more serious implications in the material world and other realms. It might even be considered just shy of murder among certain mages.

Under those circumstances, that one XP looks pretty cheap, particularly if the mage's choice results in Wisdom loss which the rules require XP to raise.

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06-15-2015, 09:20 PM #28

I've always taken the way merits work to suggest that, in a case like this, you could use the Familiar spell to bind a spirit as a Familiar, without buying the Merit, but then if it gets destroyed, you're just out. Spending the XP for the merit

signals "this familiar is important to me, if you're going to take it away, I should get something back"

It's like Allies, where you can have, narratively speaking, allies in the game without having merit dots, but they're not mechanically enforced, and you don't get anything back if you piss them off and they stop talking to you.

**Eolirin**
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 450

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06-17-2015, 02:38 PM #29

Wait...does that mean the spirit could Claim someone and still be a familiar?

**That Other Guy**
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 702

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06-17-2015, 03:04 PM #30

Oh man, Familiars suddenly have appeal to me for a specific kind of character I'd love to play.

**wulf**
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 493

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